01 / AT THE CAMERA

Mike’s camera field guide

Convention center / IMS • October 23, 2026

Steady. Sharp. Usable. Confirm the shot, recording expectations and adjustment owners before show.

Ask the director first

“What camera number am I? Am I the only camera? Is my feed ISO recorded, and when can I reframe? What’s my default shot? Who handles iris, shading and white balance?”

• Agree whether to hold the lectern or follow walk-ups, exits and roaming speakers. Confirm panels and the speaker sequence.

• Check comms, talk button, tally and any return/program view. Identify the video lead, breaks, strike duties and release time.

Before doors

• **Read the actual model labels.** The Fujinon and Cartoni examples in this guide are references; Mike’s exact rig remains unconfirmed.

• **Check the built rig with the lead.** Platform, tripod, mounts, cable clearance and movement range. Keep attendees off the camera platform.

• **Support the camera while checking balance.** Get help with plate position and counterbalance; set drag afterwards.

• **Identify the controls.** Pan/tilt brakes, drag, counterbalance and horizontal lock are separate from the camera plate release.

• **Test focus, zoom, viewfinder, comms and tally.** Raise problems before the show.

During show and at release

• Hold the agreed framing and keep the speaking subject sharp. With one usable camera, favor reliable coverage.

• **ISO** is a separate camera recording; **program** is the switched output. Off program is not permission to reset an ISO.

• Coordinate exposure, color, white balance and menu changes with their assigned owner. Report symptoms briefly and ask for a safe reset.

• Confirm pictures/recordings are no longer needed before parking or disconnecting. Apply the demonstrated locks and follow strike instructions.

Explore the rig in 3D
avbydave.com/boxlens
Rotate • select controls • practice balance • walk through back focus

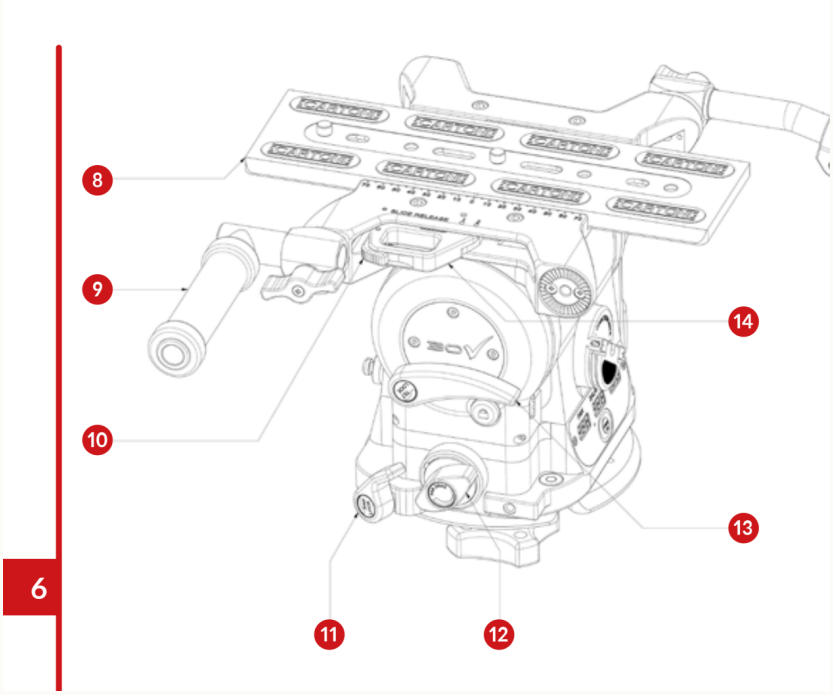
02 / HEAD CONTROLS

Find the right control

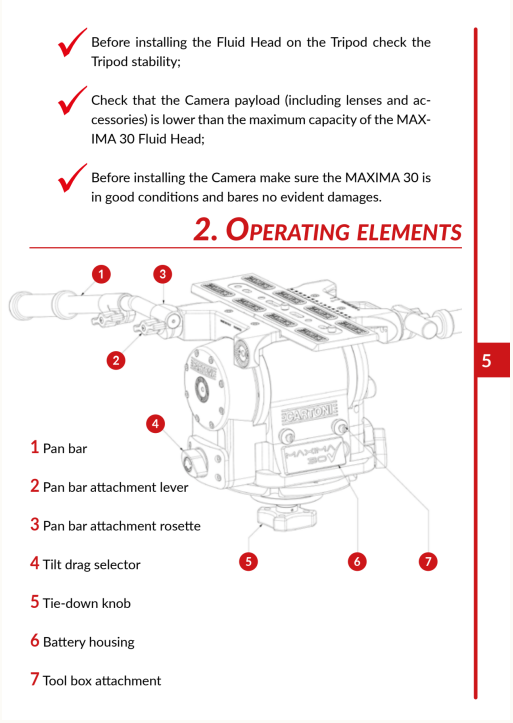
Cartoni Maxima 30 • HM3100 manufacturer reference

REFERENCE MODEL - ACTUAL GEAR NOT CONFIRMED.
Callout numbers are specific to the Maxima 30; other heads can differ. Read the actual head label and ask the video lead to identify its controls.

Pan and tilt brakes



Tilt drag side



Number	Control	Use it for
4	Tilt drag	Up/down movement resistance; not counterbalance.
11	Pan lock	Brake for left/right rotation.
12	Pan drag	Left/right movement resistance.
13	Tilt lock	Brake for up/down rotation.
14 / 10	Slide lock / safety	Camera plate adjustment and removal safety. Not axis brakes.

Support before unlocking. Have the lead demonstrate the real controls. A brake or high drag can hide poor balance.

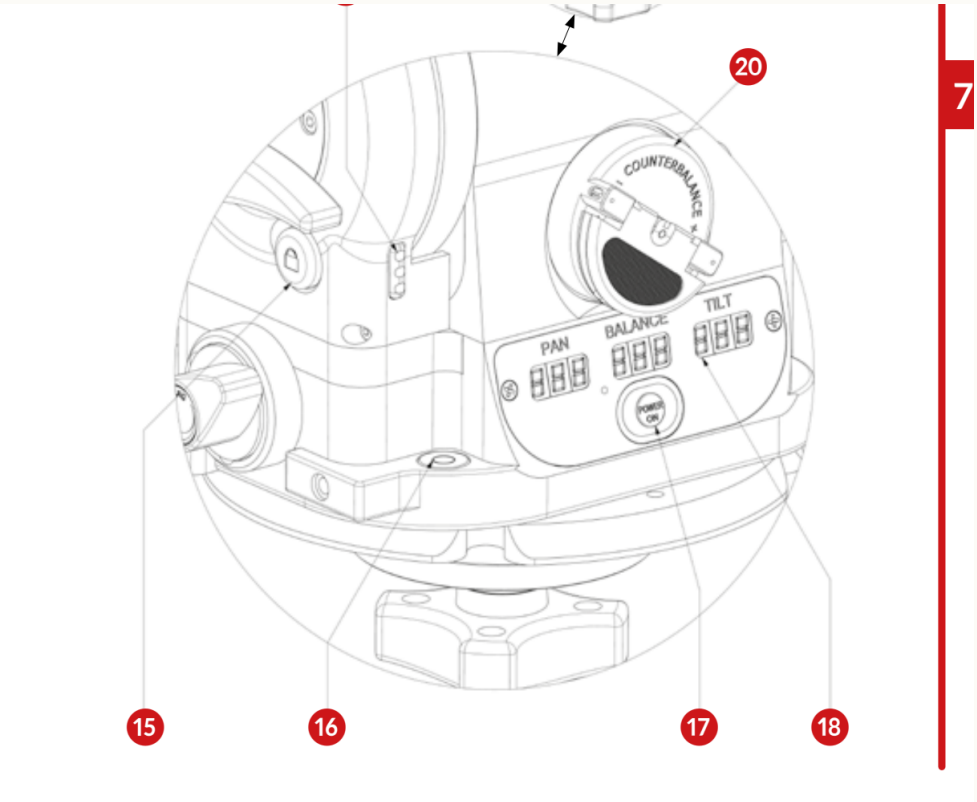
Diagram excerpts © Cartoni. Maxima 30 manual, printed pages 5 and 6.

03 / BALANCE AND COUNTERBALANCE

Balance before drag

Cartoni Maxima 30 • Rear control detail

REFERENCE MODEL - ACTUAL GEAR NOT CONFIRMED.
The diagram locates the controls; it does not prescribe settings for an unknown camera payload.



Number	Control	What matters
20	Counterbalance	Spring support for the tilted payload; different from drag.
15 / 19	Horizontal lock on / off	Holds the head at its horizontal mounting position. Support the camera before releasing.
16 / 17 / 18	Level / light / readout	References for setup; no real setting number is prescribed here.

Setup order: confirm support and full payload → balance fore/aft while supported → set counterbalance → add operating drag. Use the actual head's procedure.

Diagram excerpt © Cartoni. Maxima 30 manual, printed pages 7 to 9.

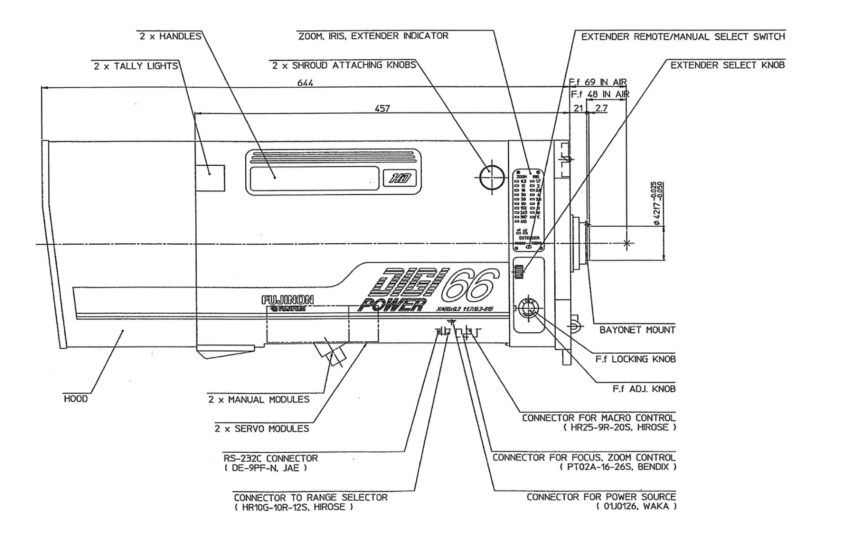
04 / BACK FOCUS

Locate the F.f controls

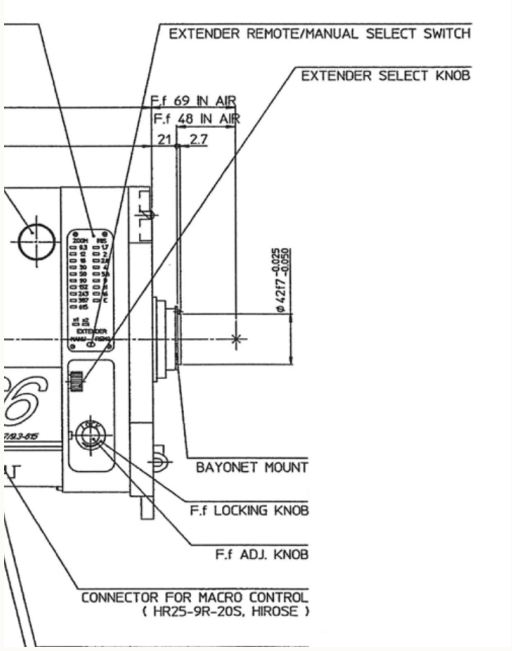
Fujinon XA66x9.3BESM family • Manufacturer leaflet reference

REFERENCE FAMILY - EXACT UNIT VARIANT NOT CONFIRMED.
This XA66-family drawing matches the family used by the 3D reference. Mike’s lens suffix and the Panasonic body model remain unconfirmed.

Lens side overview



Rear control strip detail



Label	Meaning
F.f ADJ. KNOB	Flange focal length adjustment; not the normal focus demand.
F.f LOCKING KNOB	Concentric lock for the flange focal length adjustment.

Tight is sharp but wide goes soft

“Can we check flange back before show?” The symptom warrants a check; it is not a complete diagnosis. With the video lead and the actual model’s procedure:

1. Use a suitable target at the specified distance. Monitor the image and set macro off where applicable.

2. Coordinate an open or nearly open iris and proper target exposure.

3. At telephoto use **normal focus**; at wide angle use the designated **F.f adjustment**. Alternate until both hold.

4. Secure the adjustment, check the zoom range and restore show exposure.

Confirm the controls first. Do not loosen the lens mount or open covers to hunt for a knob. The operating sequence is supported by related Fujinon manuals; use the actual lens instructions and target distance.

Drawing © Fujinon. XA66 original leaflet, page 2. Related XA77 operating procedure, printed page 8.

05 / CONFIRM AND REFERENCE

Check the assumptions

What the conversation establishes - and what to confirm on site

Topic	Practical correction
Camera and head	The viewer uses a generic Panasonic body and Maxima 30 reference. It does not establish the actual camera model, head variant or physical configuration.
CCU and shader	Panasonic cameras do not universally require CCU power. A connected CCU does not establish who shades, controls iris or performs white balance.
Recording	USB drives do not prove camera ISO recording. Confirm the input routes and the director’s recording requirements.
Back focus	The principle is supported; the exact control and setup depend on the actual lens. The XA66 drawing establishes control labels, not a complete operating procedure.
Balance	Plate position, counterbalance, drag and brakes have distinct roles. The model is qualitative; it cannot certify payload or prescribe real knob settings.
Price and booking	Prices discussed remain unverified. Confirm local General Session classifications and assigned responsibilities with the booking contact or steward.

Close these gaps before show

Actual model labels • Camera count and alternate views • Recording routes • Shading and white balance owner • Completed balance/back-focus checks • Current call and release details.

Sources and interactive reference

Open the interactive camera rig

Cartoni Maxima 30 - control diagrams and setup

Fujinon XA66x9.3BESM - original control drawing

Related Fujinon XA77 - flange focus procedure

Panasonic AK-HC3500A - external DC specifications

Panasonic AK-UC3300 - white balance and remote controls

AJA Ki Pro GO - recording inputs and destinations

Based on Mike’s October 22, 2026 call with Dave. References checked October 23, 2026. The call does not document the next-day outcome. The online model is an authored inspection reference, not manufacturer CAD or a live camera controller.